How Mercedes-Benz Uses Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Two Letters and Four Principles

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is changing our world. At Mercedes-Benz, we also see great potential in this technology. Intelligent voice assistants, automated data analyses, or AI-controlled painting processes: We use AI to make our vehicles even safer and more comfortable, to make our processes more efficient, and to offer our customers innovative products.

However, we are also aware of the risks associated with the use of AI. Data protection, security, or ethical questions – there are many challenges that we are addressing intensively. That is why a responsible approach to AI is a matter of course for us. We want to seize the opportunities while keeping our ethical and legal standards in mind.

To ensure that we develop and use AI responsibly, we defined our own principles for dealing with AI back in 2019 and anchored them company-wide in our integrity code. These principles serve as a guideline and help us to find the balance between innovation and responsibility.

The AI Principles are part of our risk-based AI Governance approach, which aims to ensure compliance with legal requirements and ethical standards. To keep up with the global dynamics of AI regulation, we can integrate new requirements into this adaptive approach as needed.

Both – AI Principles and AI Governance – are intended to strengthen trust in our company, our products and services – and at the same time provide all colleagues with guidance on how to deal with AI.

1st principle: responsible use

"We shape and use Artificial Intelligence responsibly. We realize the opportunities of Artificial Intelligence and harmonize its effects in line with our corporate values."

AI is not an end in itself. Whenever we use it, it should deliver genuine added value. This is preceded by a transparent evaluation process: Will our products, services, and processes actually become faster and more efficient through AI? What benefits does the use of this technology have for different target groups? Is our data set representative and of high enough quality to strengthen fairness and inclusion? We do not leave these considerations to a machine. Humans remain in control.

2nd principle: explainability

"We are committed to a high level of transparency, thereby promoting trust in Artificial Intelligence. To that end, we support explainable Artificial Intelligence."

In school, our teachers taught us a special rule for solving math problems: not only the correct answer counts, but also the way to get there. It's similar with calculations that are carried out with the help of AI. For example, if a piece of software evaluates a large amount of data to make forecasts about future market developments, it should be transparent which parameters it considered in the analysis. That way, we can explain any possible unintended bias – and eliminate it.

3rd principle: protection of privacy

"We respect privacy. We consider privacy protection from the design phase of Artificial Intelligence systems onwards. We support privacy-enhancing technologies."

Digital services have become an integral part of our everyday lives. They would not work without a certain amount of data. This makes it all the more important to ensure that the privacy of customers and employees remains protected. Wherever possible and reasonable, we use artificial or anonymized data sets when testing and training AI. Legal requirements are always mandatory. Data protection is a quality feature for us.

4th principle: safety and reliability

"We develop and test our AI technologies consciously and according to state-of-the-art science and technology. We take adequate measures to develop safe and reliable Artificial Intelligence."

Safety and reliability are an integral part of our brand's core. We therefore apply our high quality standards to AI applications as well. Conscientious training of learning systems, scientifically validated and accepted algorithms, and the use of current technologies form the basis for this. In autonomous driving, for example, reliable AI is safety-relevant - another reason for us to work with precision and a critical mindset when developing new technologies.

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Digital Trust.

As one of six focus areas, Digital Trust is therefore an essential part of our holistic understanding of sustainability at Mercedes-Benz. The mobility of the future will be shaped by digital technologies and services. They are an integral part of our vehicles.

Digital Trust Overview

The Mercedes-Benz Group.

The Mercedes-Benz Group AG (former Daimler AG) is one of the world's most successful automotive companies. With Mercedes-Benz AG, the Group offers a wide range of high-end passenger cars and premium vans. Mercedes-Benz Financial Services is another key pillar of the Group and plays a central role in the financial services business.

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[1] Net carbon-neutral means that carbon emissions that are not avoided or reduced at Mercedes-Benz are compensated for by certified offsetting projects.

[2] Green Charging uses Energy Attribute Certificates to ensure that an equivalent amount of electricity from renewable energy sources is fed into the power grid for charging processes in “MB.CHARGE Public”, if no electricity from renewable energy sources is provided. For this purpose, high-quality green electricity certificates are used, which verifiably certify the origin of the energy and serve as a kind of birth certificate for electricity from renewable energies.

* The specified values were determined in accordance with the WLTP (Worldwide harmonised Light vehicles Test Procedure) measurement method. The ranges given refer to ECE markets. The energy consumption and CO_2 emissions of a car depend not only on the efficient utilisation of the fuel or energy source by the car, but also on the driving style and other non-technical factors.

** Electric energy consumption and range have been determined on the basis of Regulation (EC) No. 692/2008 according to NEDC. Electric energy consumption and range depend on the vehicle configuration.

*** Data on electrical consumption and range are provisional and were determined internally in accordance with the “WLTP test procedure” certification method. So far there are no confirmed figures from an officially approved testing organisation, nor any EC type approval or certificate of conformity with official figures. Differences between the stated figures and the official figures are possible.